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FJ 10310/14(A)

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THE UNITED STATES AND JAPAN'S RELATIONS WITH CHINA.

FLAG A.

The Prime Minister's minute (attached) states that he wishes to discuss this subject with the Secretary of State on the journey to the United States.

FJ1071/2

FLAG B.

2. The series of telegrams on this subject is attached. The two briefs for the Prime Minister's visit to Washington which deal with this subject (Nos. GEN. 396/5 (Final) and 396/8 (Final)) recommend that United States agreement should be secured:

FC1024/2

(a) to bring no further pressure to bear upon Japan to sign a "peace treaty" with the nationalist authorities in Formosa;

(b) to permit Japan to trade with the Chinese mainland in commodities not on our prohibited or restricted lists; and

(c) to allow Japan to decide her future relations with China after the Peace Treaty has come into force.

Present Position.

FJ10310/39

FJ10310/43

FLAG C.

FLAG D.

The latest exchange of views between the Secretary of State and Mr. Acheson is contained in Foreign Office telegram No. 6119 [16th December] and Washington telegram No. 3900 [of 18th December]. Neither Mr. Dulles nor the United States Government have made any further proposals for a compromise policy on this subject, which would take into account the Secretary of State's views and also the United States administration's probable difficulties in getting the Senate to ratify the Japanese Peace Treaty. From conversations with the United States Embassy

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it seems likely that the United States Government will wish to discuss this subject during the Prime Minister's visit to Washington.

(J.A. Pilcher)

28th December, 1951.

We now know definitely, from the President's message, that this subject will be raised.

The Americans take a keen interest in this, partly for strategic and partly for domestic political reasons. To us it is less important than policy towards China or the defence of South East Asia; and if yielding a little on the Formosan issue helped us to secure American agreement on these bigger issues I consider that it would be worth our while to do so It is true that any Japanese arrangement with Chiang Kai Shek will irritate Peking, but the major irritant to Peking is the denial of the island - on which we and the Americans are agreed.

(R.H. Scott)
28.12.51

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